

Bei Xujiacao Map Viewer

A short guide to exploring excavation layers,
annotating the map, and saving images for reports.

Open the viewer in your web browser. No special software is required.

Public site: <https://ywzhou997.github.io/BeiXujiacao/>

1. Browsing layers

The left panel lists archaeological layers. You can browse them in two ways:

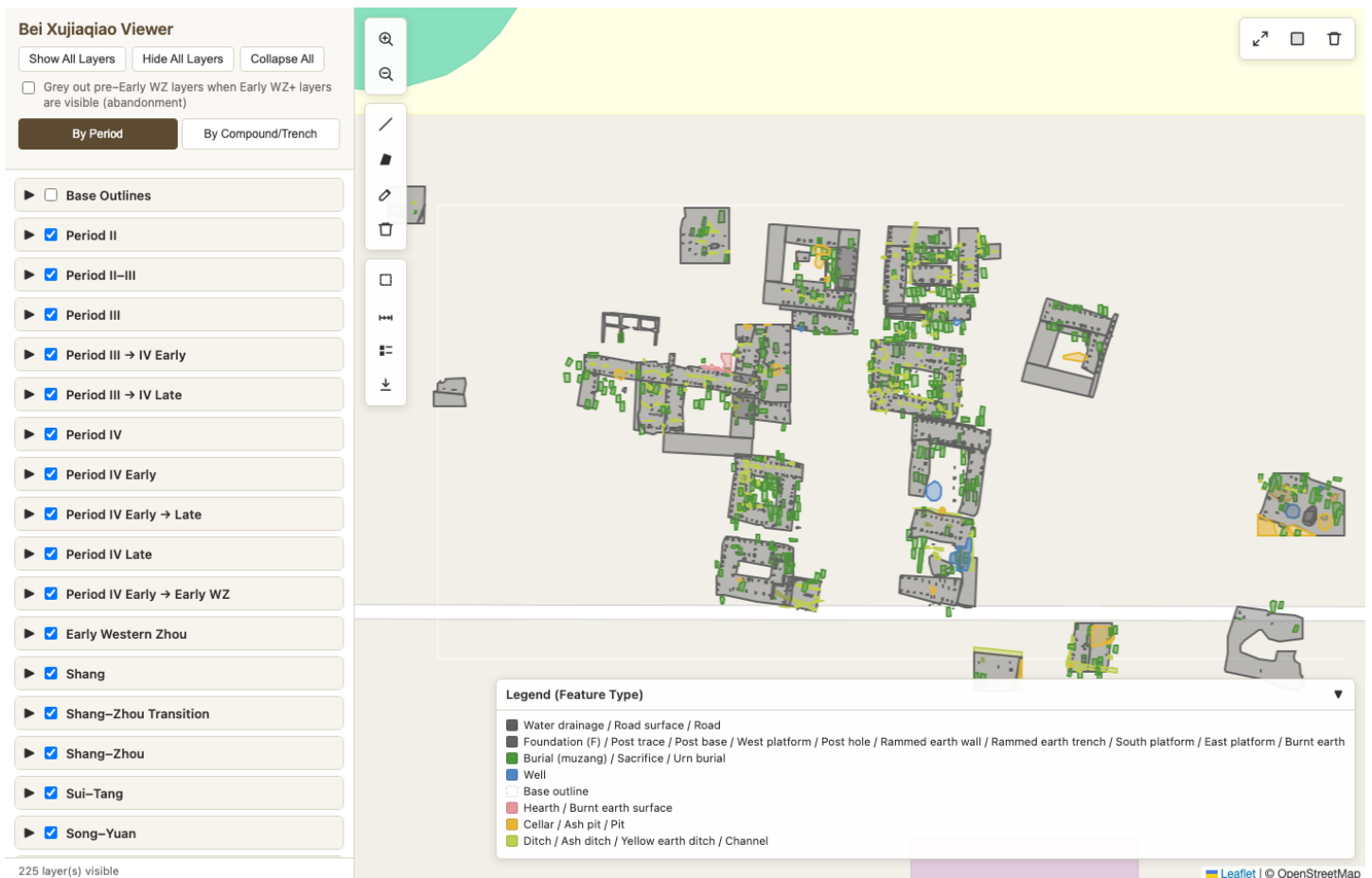
By Period groups features by time period (for example, Period IV Early or Early Western Zhou). This is the default view when you open the page.

By Compound/Trench groups features by excavation area (for example, Compound I or T19). Click the tab at the top of the panel to switch views. The same layers appear in both tabs; only the grouping changes.

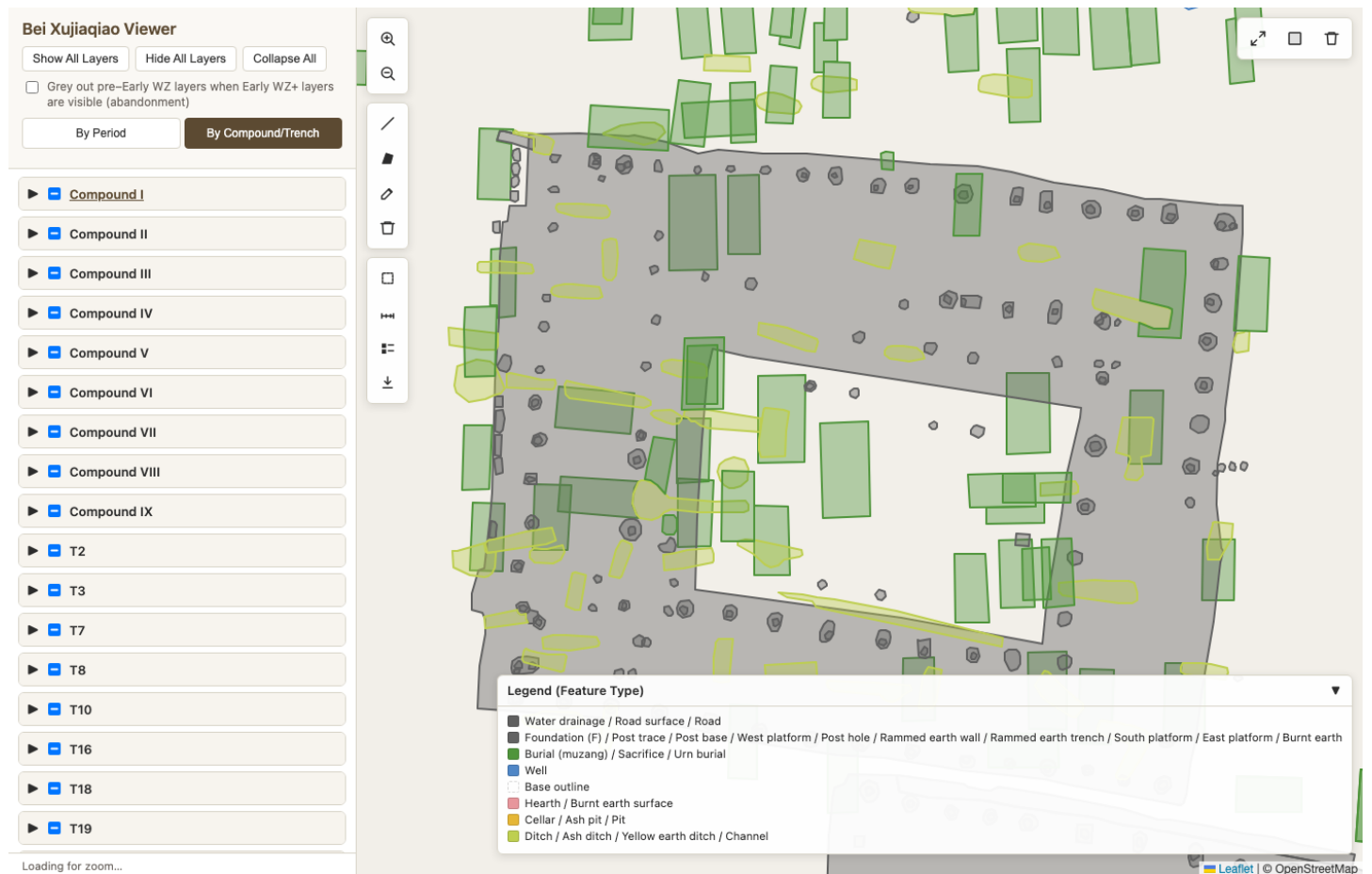
Use the checkboxes beside each layer name to show or hide features on the map. You can also open a group header to see its layers.

Show All Layers turns everything on. Hide All Layers turns everything off.

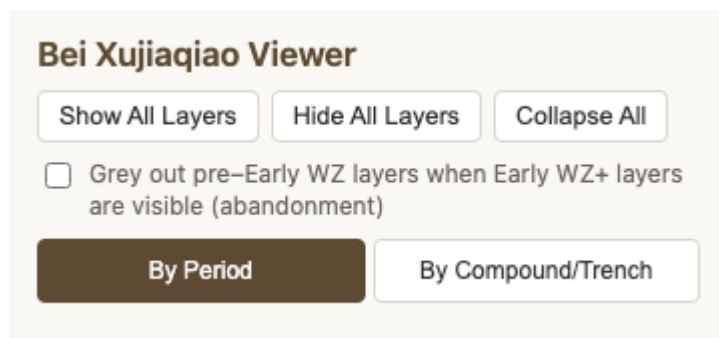
Grey out pre-Early WZ layers is optional. When checked, older remains appear in grey if you are also viewing layers from Early Western Zhou or later. This helps highlight what may have been abandoned in later periods.



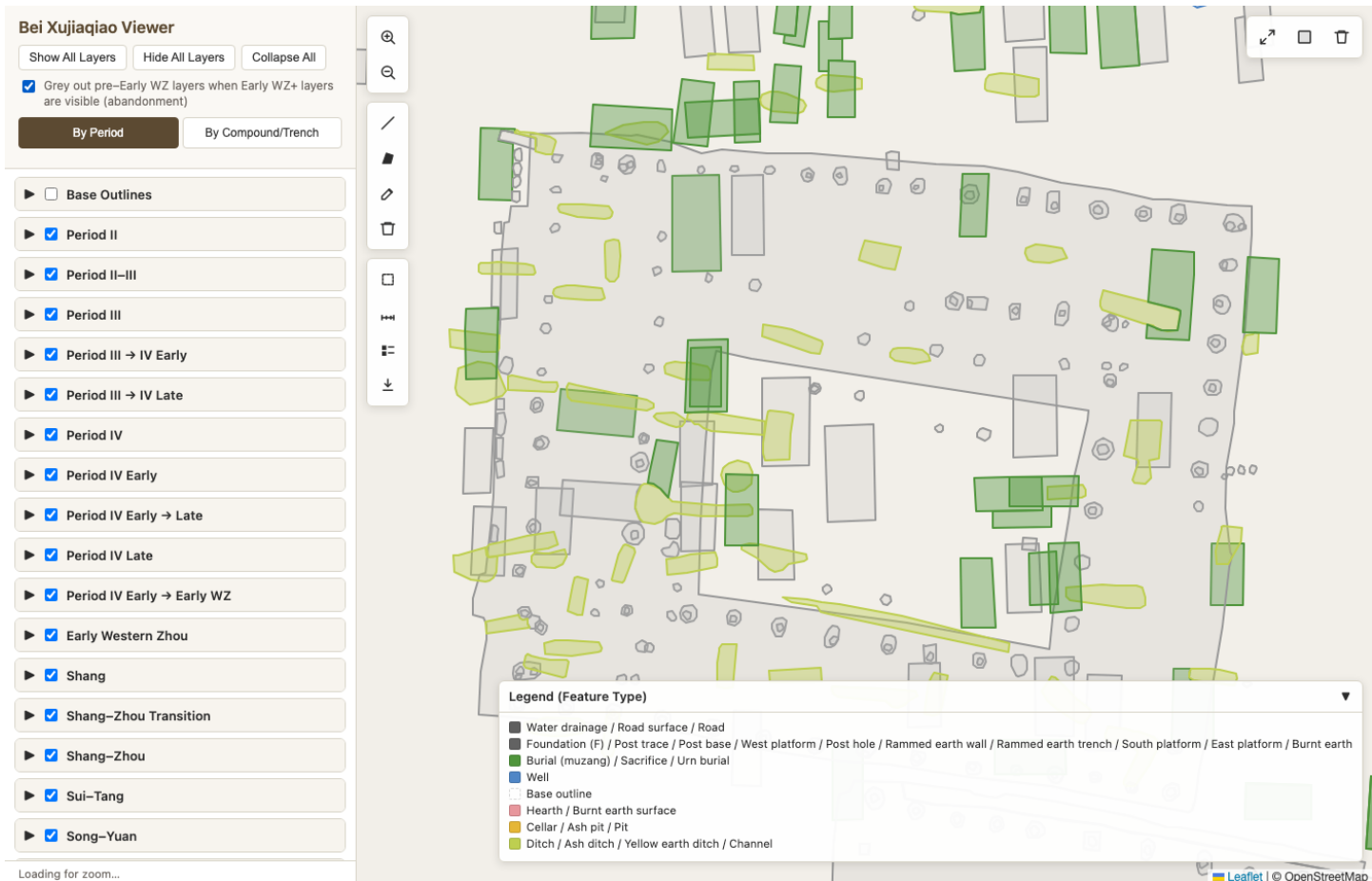
By Compound/Trench view



Layer controls (close-up)



With abandonment mode on, earlier visible layers can appear grey on the map:



2. Zooming the map

On the left side of the map you will find two zoom buttons.

Zoom In makes the map larger so you can see detail. Zoom Out shows a wider area.

You can also use your mouse scroll wheel or trackpad to zoom. Drag the map to pan.

The Fit All button (top right of the map) brings all currently selected layers back into view.



3. Drawing on the map

The Sketch tools let you add simple marks on top of the map. These are for notes and illustrations; they are not saved permanently when you close the browser.

Draw Line adds a straight line. Click on the map to place points, then double-click or finish to complete the line.

Draw Polygon adds a closed shape. Click corners, then finish the shape.

Edit Layer lets you adjust a sketch you already drew. Delete Layer removes selected sketches.

Clear Sketches (top right) removes all drawings at once.



Sketch tool icons (left toolbar):



4. Saving a map image (export workflow)

Follow these steps when you need a clean picture for a report or presentation:

Step 1 - Draw Screenshot Area: click the dashed-rectangle icon, then drag on the map to mark the region you want in the final image.

Step 2 - Place Scale Bar: click the ruler icon to show a scale bar inside the screenshot area. Drag it to move it; drag the small corner handle to resize.

Step 3 - Legend: click the legend icon, then tick the feature types you want in the export legend. A separate small legend appears on the map. Drag it to position it inside the screenshot frame.

Step 4 - Download: click the download icon to save a PNG image of the screenshot area, including the scale bar and export legend.

Tip: draw the screenshot area first. The scale bar and export legend stay in place relative to that frame when you zoom or pan.

Bei Xujiqiao Viewer

Show All Layers Hide All Layers Collapse All

☐ Grey out pre-Early WZ layers when Early WZ+ layers are visible (abandonment)

By Period By Compound/Trench

- ☐ Base Outlines
- ☒ Period II
- ☒ Period II-III
- ☒ Period III
- ☒ Period III → IV Early
- ☒ Period III → IV Late
- ☒ Period IV
- ☒ Period IV Early
- ☒ Period IV Early → Late
- ☒ Period IV Late
- ☒ Period IV Early → Early WZ
- ☒ Early Western Zhou
- ☒ Shang
- ☒ Shang-Zhou Transition
- ☒ Shang-Zhou
- ☒ Sui-Tang
- ☒ Song-Yuan

Screenshot area defined. Use Download to export.

Export legend

Legend (Feature Type)

- Water drainage / Road surface / Road
- Foundation (F) / Post trace / Post base / West platform / Post hole / Rammed earth wall / Rammed earth trench / South platform / East platform / Burnt earth
- Burial (muzang) / Sacrifice / Urn burial
- Well
- Base outline
- Hearth / Burnt earth surface
- Cellar / Ash pit / Pit
- Ditch / Ash ditch / Yellow earth ditch / Channel

Export tool icons:



5. Blank background

By default the map shows a standard street map underneath the excavation layers.

For publication-ready figures, click Blank Background (top right, square icon). The street map is replaced with a plain white background.

Click the same button again (now labelled OSM basemap) to restore the street map.

Blank background works the same way as the normal map: you can still zoom, pan, toggle layers, draw, and export images.

